

CONNAR ELLINGTON

connarellington@gmail.com | Stockton-on-Tees, UK | 07305157505 | [LinkedIn](#)

Full UK Driving Licence & Vehicle | British Citizen — Right to Work in UK

SOC ANALYST PROFILE

Summary

SOC-focused analyst with CompTIA CySA+ certification and hands-on experience monitoring, triaging, and investigating security alerts in a live enterprise environment — including phishing and attachment analysis using Mimecast and VirusTotal, and endpoint threat monitoring via BitDefender. Skilled in SIEM-based log analysis, packet analysis, and incident triage through structured home-lab practice (Splunk, Wireshark, MITRE ATT&CK, TryHackMe/HackTheBox), with a consistent track record of clear communication across technical and non-technical stakeholders. Comfortable working under pressure in fast-paced environments with a strong foundation in ITIL-aligned incident handling.

SKILLS

Security Monitoring & Analysis: Security Alert Monitoring & Triage | SIEM Log Analysis (Splunk) | Phishing & Email Threat Analysis (Mimecast) | Threat Intelligence & IOC Verification (VirusTotal) | Endpoint Detection & Response (BitDefender) | Network Traffic Analysis (Wireshark) | MITRE ATT&CK Framework (familiarity)

Technical Foundations: Active Directory & Azure AD | PowerShell Scripting | Network Fundamentals (TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Firewalls) | Windows Server 2016/2019 | Vulnerability Remediation (Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001)

Ways of Working: ITIL-Aligned Incident Management | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Clear Technical Communication | Working Under Pressure in Fast-Paced Environments

CAREER EXPERIENCE

Selective Travel Management | Remote | November 2025 – July 2026

IT Operations Engineer

- Strengthened organisational security posture by triaging phishing emails via Mimecast and analysing suspicious attachments using VirusTotal for IOC verification, alongside monitoring endpoint alerts through BitDefender, contributing to the identification and containment of email-based threats across a 200-user
- Maintained secure, uninterrupted business operations by administering Active Directory, Azure AD, and Microsoft 365 environments, supporting approximately 200 users with zero major access-related incidents.
- Delivered consistent IT and security support at scale by resolving 60–100 tickets per week spanning standard IT issues and phishing/email-threat analysis, maintaining high resolution throughput while sustaining service quality.
- Reduced organisational risk from faulty updates by acting as a pilot tester for new software patches and deployments across a 200-user environment, validating stability before wider rollout and escalating any issues ahead of full deployment.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification success by leading vulnerability remediation, endpoint hardening, and compliance activities across IT operations, helping the business achieve certification on schedule.
- Supported ISO 27001-aligned security compliance by maintaining documentation and operational controls across IT systems, contributing to sustained audit-readiness
- Increased operational efficiency by designing PowerShell automation scripts for administrative tasks, reducing manual processing time across recurring IT operations workflows.
- Restored system functionality and productivity by diagnosing authentication failures, connectivity issues, and endpoint performance bottlenecks.

Global Service Desk Analyst

- Delivered first- and second-line technical support at enterprise scale by supporting a global user base of 1,000+ across multiple regions, resolving 50+ tickets weekly including access issues, update failures, and endpoint faults.
- Maintained secure and compliant user access management by administering accounts, permissions, and mailboxes through Azure AD and Exchange Admin Center for 1,000+ users, reducing access-related risk across a large-scale environment.
- Improved cross-team incident resolution by coordinating with infrastructure, network, and security teams on escalated technical issues, accelerating resolution for complex, cross-functional problems.
- Increased user confidence and reduced repeat contact by translating complex technical issues into clear, accessible guidance for global users and senior leadership.

Virgin Media | Preston Industrial Park, Stockton-on-Tees | 2019 - 2024

Customer Retentions Advisor (Technical Support)

- Reduced engineer callouts and service costs by guiding customers through structured network and connectivity troubleshooting, resolving approximately 75% of issues remotely without requiring a dispatch.
- Strengthened team capability by coaching and mentoring 20+ new starters on troubleshooting procedures and customer handling.

HOME LAB & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

I operate personal home labs using VMware and VirtualBox to simulate enterprise environments for security monitoring and incident response. Within these labs, I configure Active Directory and Windows Server systems to generate realistic attack surfaces, then perform defensive and offensive exercises through TryHackMe and Hack the Box — including packet capture analysis with Wireshark and mapping attacker behaviour to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. My focus areas include SIEM log analysis (Splunk), alert triage, and incident documentation to mirror real SOC workflows.

Defensive Security

MITRE ATT&CK mapping | Vulnerability assessment & management | Endpoint security & access control | Network traffic analysis | SIEM log analysis & alert triage | Log correlation | Incident response workflows

Offensive Security (THM / HTB / eJPT prep)

Reconnaissance & enumeration | Scanning & service identification | Privilege escalation (Windows/Linux) | Lateral movement & pivoting | Password attack techniques | Credential harvesting | Web application testing basics

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+) CS0-003 — 2026

CompTIA A+ (220-1101 & 220-1102) — 2024

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (MS-900) — 2025

Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) — 2025

Introduction to Ethical Hacking — Code Academy, 2023

In Progress: eJPT (Expected July 2026) — hands-on offensive security cert focused on reconnaissance, enumeration, and exploitation

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Event & Sales Management, Teesside University, Middlesbrough, 2015

NCFE Level 3 in Cyber Security Practices, Think Employment, 2023